PROTECTIVE GARMENTS FOR FIRE FIGHTERS

Decontamination Of The Garment

PROTECTION YOU DESERVE
YOU

Many fire combustion products including hydrocarbons, polynuclear aromatic compound, metals such as cadmium and chromium, acids and soot are hazardous to the fire fighter. These substances can become embedded in the fibres of your garments, penetrate inner layers, and enter the body through ingestion, absorption, inhalation, and parenteral contact. In addition, particules and other products of combustion can reduce the flame resistance of your garments and increase your garments' ability to conduct electricity. To reduce the risk of long term harm from hazardous substances present in the products of fire combustion, or hazardous chemicals, you MUST wash your garments. Your garments may be exposed to body fluids that may contain bloodborne pathogens. The washing procedures described in this poster will reduce your risk of infection from these hazards.

FREQUENCY

Regardless of usage, the garment must undergo cleaning **at six-month intervals.**

Immediate cleaning is required if the garment is contaminated with blood, tar, fuel, paint, acid, or any other hazardous materials.

MACHINE WASHING

Before washing, **make sure you comply with** all federal, state, and local guidelines for handling effluents from utility sinks.

Where provided, **fasten all hooks and dees** or other metal parts and turn the garment inside our or place in a large laundry bag that can be tied shut to avoid damage to the garment or to the washtub.

CLEANING PRODUCT

Never use chlorine bleach or chlorinated detergents to clean your garments. Even small amounts of chlorine will seriously reduce your garments' protective qualities.

Non-chlorinated bleaches are **acceptable.**

You may choose an **industrial cleaning agent** and must read the instructions and the label of the garment.

MACHINE CHOICE

Use a **front loading extractor** or front loading washing machine with a tumbling action for washing.

Do not use a top loading machine, because it will not wash your garments as throughly, and the agitator may damage the garment and reduce its durability and protective value.

- Wash temperature should not exceed 60°C
- Normal cycle
- Double rinsing removes residual dirt
- and insures detergent removal.

WASHING INSTRUCTIONS

- Load machine with garments to be washed,
- Select the appropriate washing programme,
- All the closure systems **must be closed** (velcros, zippers, etc.)
- In case that the outershell is oily or greasy **soak the garment in a washtub** before machine wash.
- Always wash your garments **separately** from other items.
- **Do not** use soap.
- **Prefer liquid** cleaning agents.

DRYING INSTRUCTIONS

- Remove garments from washing machine and **turn them inside out** to exposure the inner surfaces.
- **Do not** use automatic dryers because the mechanical action and excessive heat **may damage or shrink** your garments.
- Dry **by hanging in a shaded area** that recieves good cross ventilation or use a fan to circulate the air.

MANUAL CLEANING

Preparation: Wear rubber gloves for the protection of hands against chemicals.

If the garment's inner layers are replaceable, **remove the inner layers.**

Cleaning Agents: Liquid cleaning agents used for washing. Make sure water temperature **does not exceed 40°C**. Using a hand brush, gently scrub surfaces of inner iner and outer shell.

Overscrubbing may damage yo**ur garment's materials or reduce its useful life.**

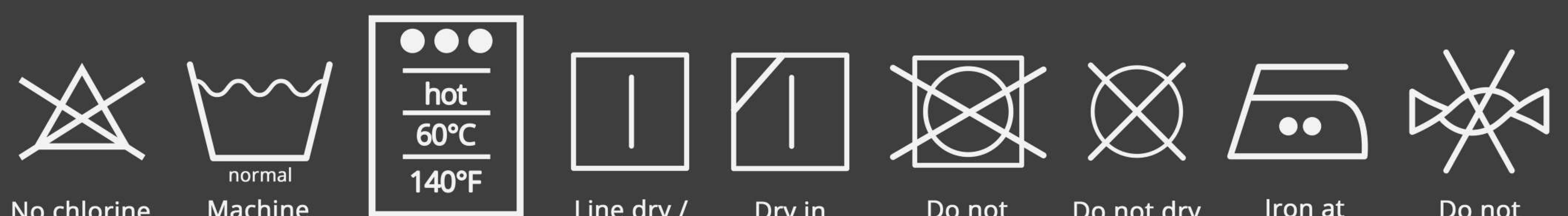
WATER REPELLENT FINISHING APPLICATION

The garment be ironed **after every washing** in order to prevent losing its water repellent feature.

Besides, in appropriate cycles, **water repellent finishing should be applied** to bring water repellency back.

HAZARDOUS SUBSTANCES

Stop using garments incase of exposure to hazardous substances.
Identification of the hazardous substances will enable the easiest cleaning.
If your garment can not be decontaminated, it must be disposed off.



No chlorine bleach	Machine wash cycle	Water temperature, should not exceed 60°C or 140°F	Line dry / hang to dry	Dry in shade	Do not tumble dry	Do not dry clean	Iron at medium temperature (Do not iron reflective strips!)	Do not wring

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